ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

NC(V) LEVEL 4

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PRACTICE EXAM

MARKS: 100 **TIME: 3 hours**

NC(V) fundamental subject, Level 4. Section A: Comprehension (30) · Section B: Summary (10) · Section C: Language in context – infographic, critical language awareness and language structures (25) · Section D: Writing (35). All texts were written by Academic Central.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the NC(V) subject guidelines for NC(V) Level 4. It is not a Department of Higher Education and Training examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of FOUR sections: SECTION A: Comprehension (30), SECTION B: Summary (10), SECTION C: Language in context (25) and SECTION D: Writing (35).
2. Answer ALL the questions in Sections A, B and C. In Section D, answer ONE question from Question 4 and ONE question from Question 5.
3. Read all the texts carefully before you answer the questions.
4. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
5. Answer in full sentences unless you are told otherwise. Use your own words where asked.
6. Write neatly and legibly.

SECTION A: COMPREHENSION

QUESTION 1

Read the article below and answer the questions that follow.

Will a Machine Take My Job?

1 Every few months a new headline warns that artificial intelligence (AI) is about to replace millions of workers. Chatbots now answer customer queries, software writes reports, and robots on factory floors work through the night without complaining. For a young person about to enter the job market, it is natural to feel anxious. Yet history suggests that the story is more complicated – and more hopeful – than the headlines admit.

2 When automatic teller machines (ATMs) spread in the 1980s and 1990s, many people predicted the end of bank tellers. Instead, because each branch became cheaper to run, banks opened more branches, and tellers moved from counting cash to advising customers. The machines took over tasks, not entire jobs. Economists call this "task substitution": technology changes what workers do rather than whether they work.

3 This does not mean that nobody will lose out. Jobs that consist mainly of predictable, repetitive tasks – capturing data, sorting parcels, answering the same question a hundred times a day – are the most likely to be automated. Workers in these positions will need to retrain, and the transition can be painful, especially in a country with high unemployment such as South Africa.

4 At the same time, new roles are appearing. Someone has to install, programme, maintain and repair the machines. Solar technicians, drone operators, data analysts and robotics technicians barely existed as job titles twenty years ago. Moreover, skills that machines struggle with – empathy, negotiation, creativity, and the ability to solve unfamiliar problems on site – are becoming more valuable, not less. A robot can tighten a bolt; it cannot calm down an angry client whose factory has stopped.

5 The real danger, therefore, is not the machine itself but standing still. Workers who keep learning, who are comfortable with technology and who can work with people will find that AI becomes a tool

in their hands rather than a rival. As one engineering lecturer told her final-year students: "Don't compete with the machine. Learn to drive it."

1.1	Name THREE examples from paragraph 1 of how technology is already doing work that people used to do.	(3)
1.2	Why might a young person feel "anxious" (paragraph 1)?	(1)
1.3	What did people predict would happen when ATMs became common, and what actually happened?	(4)
1.4	Explain the term "task substitution" in your own words.	(2)
1.5	Which kinds of jobs are most at risk of automation? Give TWO examples from the text.	(3)
1.6	Why could the change to new technology be especially "painful" in South Africa?	(2)
1.7	Name FOUR new job titles mentioned in paragraph 4.	(2)
1.8	Explain the contrast in the sentence: "A robot can tighten a bolt; it cannot calm down an angry client whose factory has stopped."	(3)
1.9	According to paragraph 5, what is "the real danger"?	(2)
1.10	Explain the metaphor in the lecturer's advice: "Don't compete with the machine. Learn to drive it."	(2)
1.11	Is the writer's attitude to AI mainly negative, neutral or optimistic? Quote a word or phrase from paragraph 1 to support your answer.	(2)
1.12	Identify ONE fact and ONE opinion in the article.	(2)
1.13	Which skills from paragraph 4 do you already have, and which would you like to develop? Explain briefly.	(2)

[30]

SECTION B: SUMMARY

QUESTION 2

Read the text below. Summarise, in point form, SEVEN things you should do to prepare for a job interview.

1. Write SEVEN points in full sentences, numbered 1 to 7.
2. Use your OWN words as far as possible.
3. Your summary must not be longer than 80 words. Write the number of words at the end.

Walking into the Interview Room with Confidence

Preparation is the secret behind most successful interviews. Begin by researching the company: read its website and find out what it does and who its clients are. Study the job advertisement carefully and think of examples from your studies or practical work that show you have the required skills. Practise answering common questions aloud, perhaps with a friend playing the role of the interviewer. Prepare two or three thoughtful questions of your own to ask at the end. Plan your route

the day before and aim to arrive about fifteen minutes early. Choose neat, appropriate clothes that suit the workplace. Finally, take copies of your CV, certificates and ID in a folder so that you are ready if the panel asks for them.

[10]

SECTION C: LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

QUESTION 3

Study the infographic and answer the questions.

YOUTH IN SOUTH AFRICA: SKILLS AND WORK (fictional survey of 2 000 young people aged 18–30)	
Completed a TVET or university qualification	38%
Of those, found work within 12 months	61%
Without a post-school qualification, found work within 12 months	27%
Say they have "good" or "very good" digital skills	54%
Have ever done an internship or work-integrated learning	22%
"Skills open doors. Experience keeps them open."	

3.1 According to the infographic, how much more likely are young people with a post-school qualification to find work within 12 months than those without one? Show your calculation. (2)

3.2 What message is the slogan at the bottom of the infographic trying to convey? (2)

3.3 Why is it important that the infographic states that the survey is fictional and how many people took part? (2)

3.4 A newspaper headline reads: *"TVET Graduates Can't Find Jobs!"* Is this headline a fair reflection of the infographic? Explain, referring to the data. (3)

3.5 Rewrite in the passive voice: *The panel will interview the shortlisted candidates on Friday.* (2)

3.6 Rewrite in reported speech: *The lecturer asked, "Have you updated your CVs?"* (3)

3.7 Rewrite the sentence using a nominalisation (change the underlined verb into a noun): *The company decided to automate the warehouse, which shocked the workers.* (2)

3.8 Identify the type of sentence (simple, compound or complex): *Although machines are efficient, they cannot show empathy.* (1)

3.9 Explain the difference in connotation between "cheap" and "affordable" when describing a product. (2)

3.10 Insert the correct punctuation: *the companys new policy affects three groups of workers drivers packers and clerks* (3)

3.11 Replace the informal words with formal ones: *We wanna get loads of new staff ASAP.* (2)

3.12 Explain why the word "Moreover" is used at the start of a sentence in paragraph 4 of the article. (1)

[25]

SECTION D: WRITING

QUESTION 4: ESSAY

Write an essay of 300–350 words on ONE of the following topics. Give your essay a title.

4.1 Technology is creating more opportunities than it is destroying. Do you agree? [20]

4.2 The person who has influenced my career choice the most [20]

4.3 Write a story with the title *"The interview that changed everything"*. [20]

[20]

QUESTION 5: TRANSACTIONAL TEXT

Choose ONE of the following. Write 150–180 words. Use the correct format.

5.1 **Covering letter.** Write a covering letter to accompany your CV in response to an advertisement for a junior technician post at "Ithemba Engineering Services", PO Box 1100, East London, 5200. [15]

5.2 **Report.** Your workplace supervisor has asked you to write a report on the causes of a recent delay in a project at your company and to recommend ways to prevent similar delays. [15]

5.3 **Agenda and notice.** Draw up a notice and agenda for a workshop on "Preparing for the world of work" that your class is organising for Level 4 students. [15]

[15]

TOTAL: 100

END OF QUESTION PAPER